

What's the biggest spider?

The world's biggest spider is the goliath bird-eating tarantula. It is the heaviest spider, at 6.2 oz (175 g). With its legs outstretched, it is 11 in (28 cm) wide. This giant, hairy spider hunts at night, waiting to pounce on passing prey.

There are more than **42,000** different kinds of spider.

Bristly body

The hairlike bristles on the tarantula's body are used to feel vibrations. This helps tarantulas sense things around them and also makes up for their poor eyesight.

Body case

Every spider has a hard, outer layer called an exoskeleton to protect it. As it gets bigger, the spider pulls out of its exoskeleton and grows a new one.

